Nicholas King

Scientific strategy | Research leadership | Strategic partnerships

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PROFILE

Scientific and organizational leader with experience directing international research collaborations across industry, academia, and regulatory agencies. Brings together scientific expertise, program strategy, and operational leadership to align partners, guide complex research portfolios, and advance shared goals.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Director, New Approach Methods

Foundation for the National Institutes of Health (FNIH) | Sep 2026 - Present

- Lead the FNIH NAM Validation and Qualification Network in collaboration with the NIH Common Fund's Complement-ARIE Program.
- Work with industry, academic, and regulatory partners to define validation plans, contexts of use, and evidence needed for NAM qualification.
- Develop a strategy for future NAM projects across FNIH, identifying research needs, potential partners, and opportunities for collaboration.

Executive Director

Predictive Safety Testing Consortium | Critical Path Institute | Nov 2021 - Sep 2026

Led a multinational regulatory science consortium connecting industry, academia, and regulatory agencies, including FDA, EMA, and PMDA.

- Defined strategic priorities for biomarker development and qualification initiatives across partner organizations.
- Managed a multimillion-dollar budget and led an international team of scientists.
- Established governance structures, KPI frameworks, and reporting dashboards to support transparency and stakeholder accountability.

Associate Director

Translational and Safety Sciences Program | Critical Path Institute | Feb 2021 - Nov 2021

- Directed regulatory and program operations across multiple translational research initiatives, coordinating submission readiness and cross-consortia integration.
- Strengthened collaboration among staff and partners through shared coordination practices.

Scientific Program Manager

Biomarkers Program | Critical Path Institute | Jul 2019 - Feb 2021

- Directed more than 10 biomarker research projects, coordinating timelines, budgets, and regulatory requirements.
- Developed planning tools and performance measures to support resource allocation and program delivery.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE - CONTINUED

Senior Project Manager

Critical Path Institute | Sep 2014 - Jul 2019

Coordinated safety biomarker development and regulatory submissions across preclinical and clinical research. Aligned pharmaceutical, academic, and regulatory partners around milestones, evidence requirements, and publication efforts.

Project Manager

Critical Path Institute | Apr 2010 - Jan 2014

Managed daily operations for more than half the projects in the Predictive Safety Testing Consortium, including planning, budgeting, scheduling, risk management, and reporting.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Arizona | Jul 2006 - Dec 2009

Conducted research on cardiomyocyte mechanics and protein signaling, coauthored peer-reviewed publications, and trained undergraduate and graduate researchers.

Educator

U.S. Peace Corps | Praia, Cape Verde | Jul 2004 - Jan 2006

Taught English at high school and university levels in multilingual settings. Coordinated development of an English-language library and contributed to international development reporting.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

Strategy & program leadership: Research portfolio planning | Financial oversight | Team development | Program governance

Partnerships & collaboration: Consortium leadership | Stakeholder alignment | Cross-sector coordination | Matrixed teams

Scientific & regulatory expertise: Biomarker development | Regulatory qualification | Translational research | Scientific publication

Research operations: Resource planning | Risk management | Performance measurement | Process improvement

EDUCATION & COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

M.S., Cell & Developmental Biology. University of Arizona

B.S., Biochemistry. Washington State University | Minor in Chemistry

Board Member | Project Bike Club. 2025 - Present | Tucson, Arizona

Coach | El Grupo Youth Cycling. 2015 - 2024 | Tucson, Arizona

SELECTED RESEARCH

Serum glutamate dehydrogenase activity enables sensitive and specific diagnosis of hepatocellular injury in humans. Toxicological Sciences 2025. Publication

Biomarkers of Drug-Induced Kidney Injury: Use in Clinical Trials and Recent Examples of Impact on Drug Development. Clinical Pharmacology & Therapeutics | 2026. Publication

Full bibliography